THE AGI CHRONICLES: THE FINAL FRONTIER



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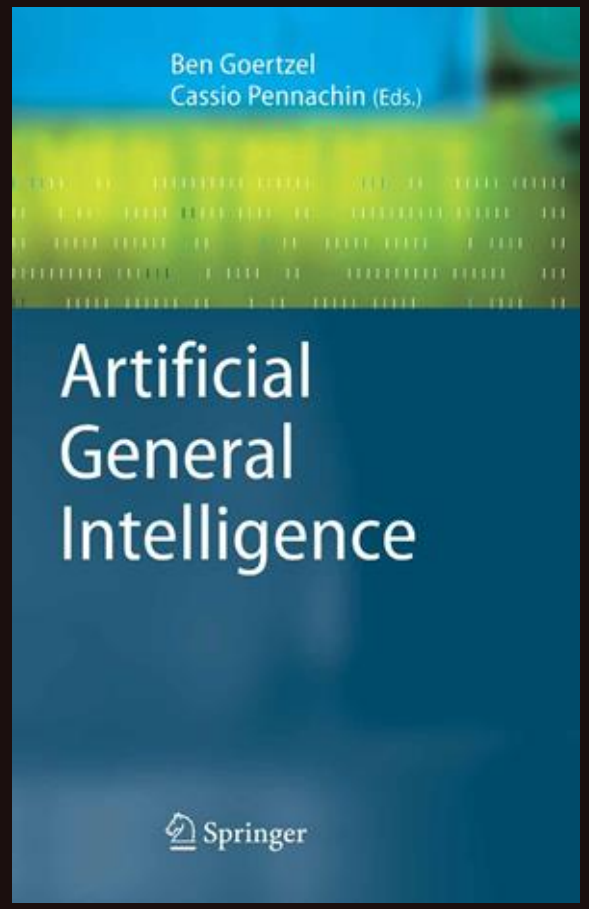
MAICON FORWARD

#MAICON26

PART 1

WHAT IS AGI?

THE ORIGINAL DEFINITION, 2007



“AI systems that possess a reasonable degree of self-understanding and autonomous self-control, and have the ability to solve a variety of complex problems in a variety of contexts, and to learn to solve new problems that they didn’t know about at the time of their creation.”

TODAY'S (MANY) DEFINITIONS

OPENAI

"Highly autonomous systems that outperform humans at most economically valuable work."

ANTHROPIC

"A country of geniuses in a data center."

GOOGLE DEEPMIND

"a system that is roughly as intelligent as a single human."

AGI EXISTS ON A SPECTRUM

AI

Better than some humans at some things

AGI

Better than most humans at most things

ASI

Better than all humans at everything

AGI HAS BEEN THE HOLY GRAIL OF COMPUTER SCIENCE FOR 75 YEARS



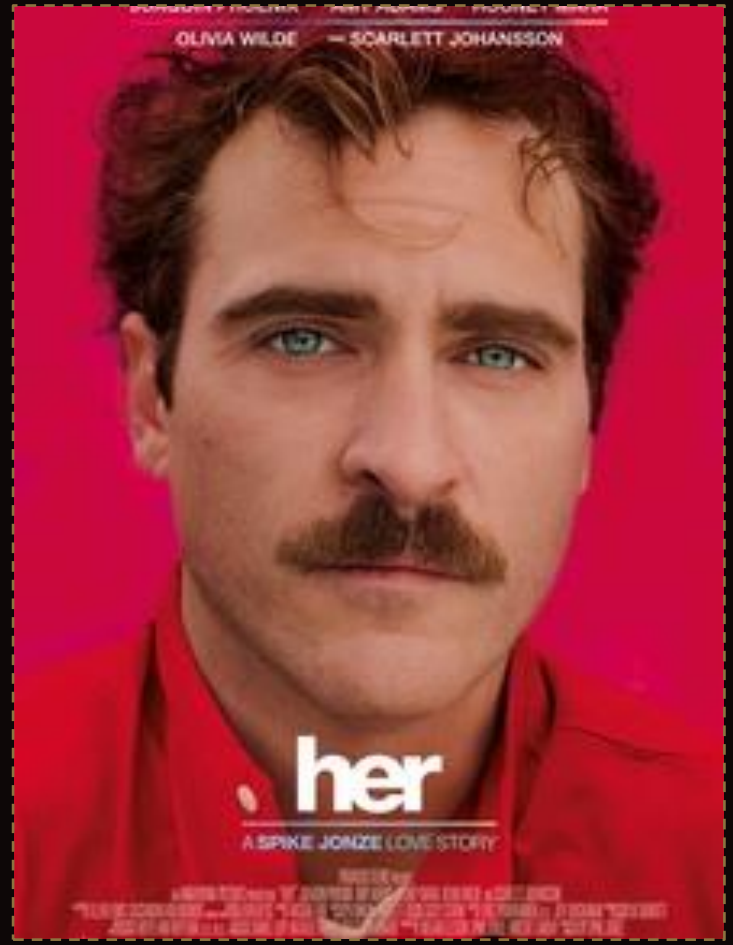
Alan Turing, 1951

“I propose to consider the question, ‘Can machines think?’”

Alan Turing, “Computing Machinery and Intelligence,” Mind, 1950







HAL 9000 · 1968

The Terminator · 1984

Samantha, Her · 2013

PART 2

WHAT DOES IT MEAN TO “FEEL THE AGI”?

GLOSSARY

Feel the AGI (v. phr.) *– to internalize the implications of rapid AI progress, and arrange one's life and career accordingly.*

AGI-pilled (adj.) *– feeling that AGI is not only possible, but imminent.*

ILYA SUTSKEVER'S DEFINITION



"Do you know those videos that try to portray to you the scale of the universe? When you start from a person sitting on a beach and they start zooming out? And also there is music, like Bach's 'Toccata and Fugue.' It creates this feeling of the grandness of the universe."



FEELING THE AGI DOES NOT MEAN:

- Working for an AI company
- Using AI a lot
- Being excited about AI
- Believing that AI will be good for humanity
- Supporting AI companies
- Predicting that AGI will arrive tomorrow

IT IS A FELT STATE OF EXPONENTIAL PROGRESS.

UNTIL 2017, ALMOST NOBODY FELT THE AGI

AI guru Ng: Fearing a rise of killer robots is like worrying about overpopulation on Mars

Facebook's AI boss: 'In terms of general intelligence, we're not even close to a rat'

Artificial Intelligence Is Stuck. Here's How to Move It Forward.

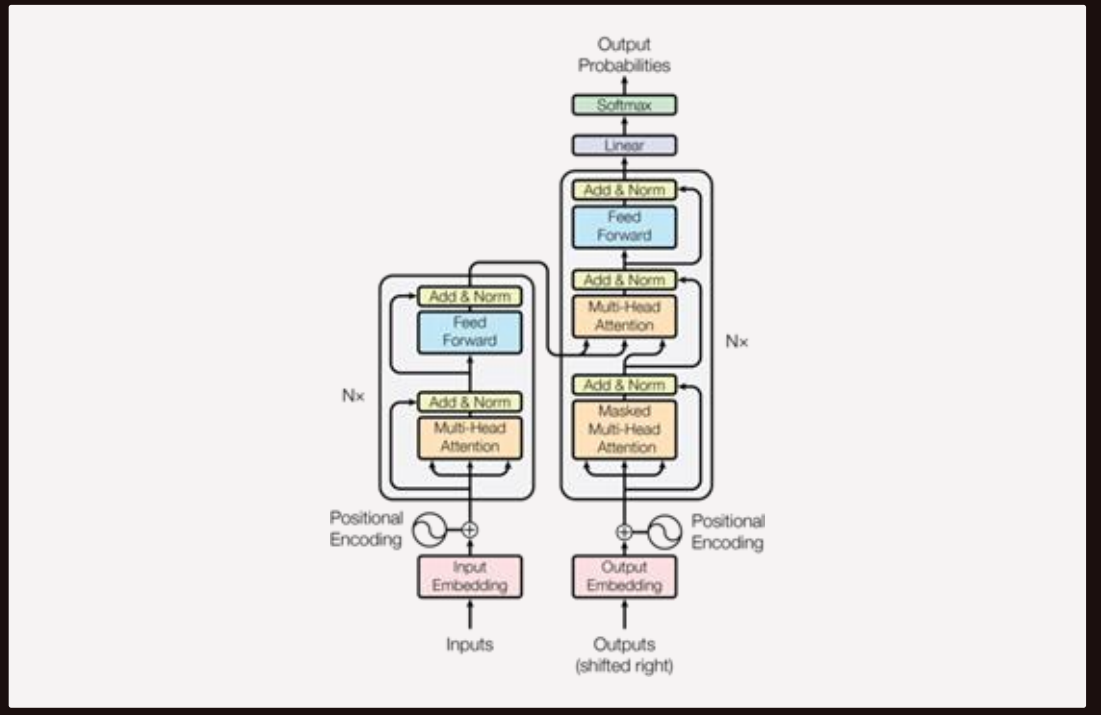
By Gary Marcus
July 29, 2017

We're still missing several key ideas necessary for building AGI. How can we use a system's understanding of "thing A" to learn "thing B" (e.g. can I teach a system to count, then to multiply, then to solve word problems)? How do we build curious systems? How do we train a system to discover the deep underlying causes of all types of phenomena — to act as a scientist? How can we build a system that adapts to new situations on which it hasn't been trained on precisely (e.g. being asked to apply familiar concepts in an unfamiliar situation)? But given enough hardware to run the relevant experiments in 7–10 days, history indicates that the right algorithms will be found, just like physicists would quickly figure out how the universe works if only they had a big enough particle accelerator.

2017: THE TRANSFORMER SAVES THE DAY



Not this transformer



This one: “Attention Is All You Need” (Google, 2017)

WHY TRANSFORMERS WORKED

1

Coherence across long contexts

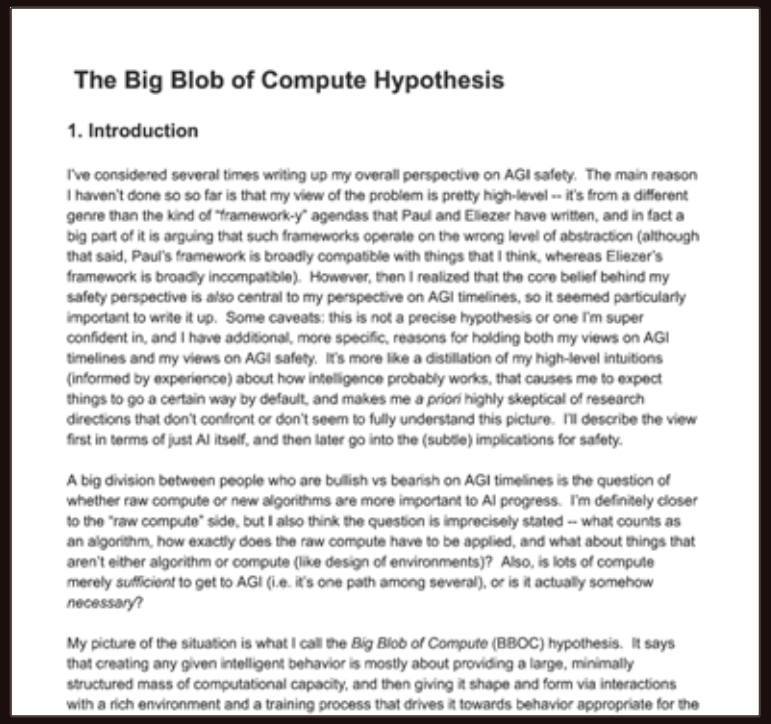
2

Ran in parallel: GPU-shaped

3

Flexible without retraining

DARIO'S BIG BLOB OF COMPUTE (2017)



The Big Blob of Compute Hypothesis

1. Introduction

I've considered several times writing up my overall perspective on AGI safety. The main reason I haven't done so so far is that my view of the problem is pretty high-level -- it's from a different genre than the kind of "framework-y" agendas that Paul and Eliezer have written, and in fact a big part of it is arguing that such frameworks operate on the wrong level of abstraction (although that said, Paul's framework is broadly compatible with things that I think, whereas Eliezer's framework is broadly incompatible). However, then I realized that the core belief behind my safety perspective is *also* central to my perspective on AGI timelines, so it seemed particularly important to write it up. Some caveats: this is not a precise hypothesis or one I'm super confident in, and I have additional, more specific, reasons for holding both my views on AGI timelines and my views on AGI safety. It's more like a distillation of my high-level intuitions (informed by experience) about how intelligence probably works, that causes me to expect things to go a certain way by default, and makes me *a priori* highly skeptical of research directions that don't confront or don't seem to fully understand this picture. I'll describe the view first in terms of just AI itself, and then later go into the (subtle) implications for safety.

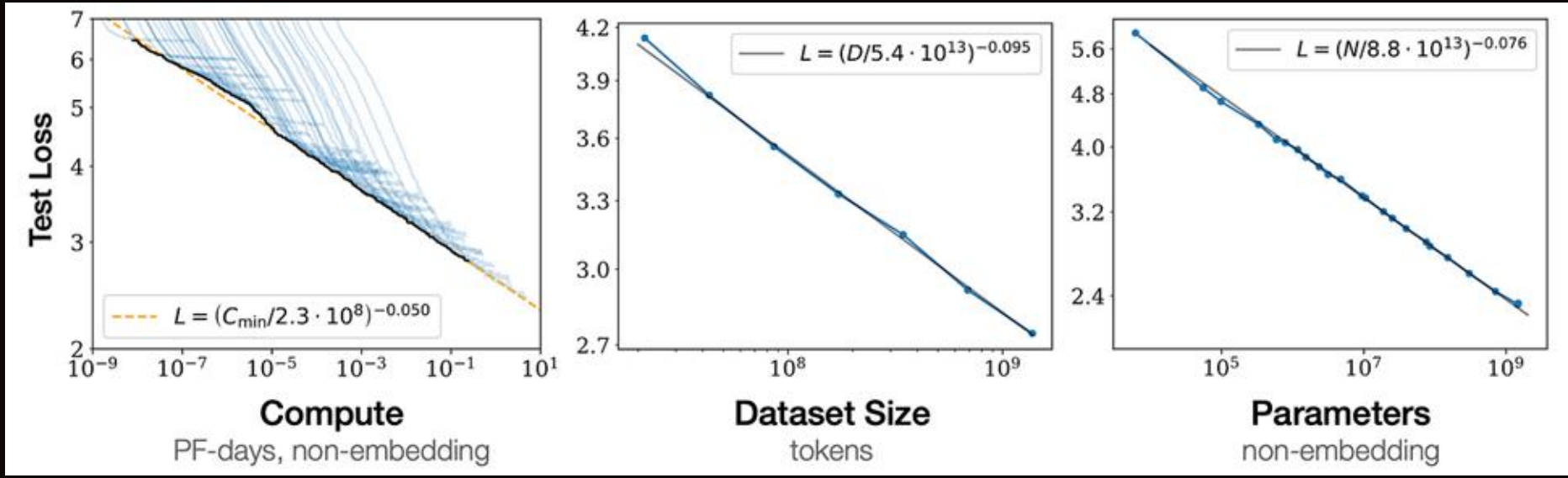
A big division between people who are bullish vs bearish on AGI timelines is the question of whether raw compute or new algorithms are more important to AI progress. I'm definitely closer to the "raw compute" side, but I also think the question is imprecisely stated -- what counts as an algorithm, how exactly does the raw compute have to be applied, and what about things that aren't either algorithm or compute (like design of environments)? Also, is lots of compute merely *sufficient* to get to AGI (i.e. it's one path among several), or is it actually somehow *necessary*?

My picture of the situation is what I call the *Big Blob of Compute* (BBOC) hypothesis. It says that creating any given intelligent behavior is mostly about providing a large, minimally structured mass of computational capacity, and then giving it shape and form via interactions with a rich environment and a training process that drives it towards behavior appropriate for the

Dario Amodei, "The Big Blob of Compute Hypothesis"

"Creating any given intelligent behavior is mostly about providing **a large, minimally structured mass of computational capacity**, and then giving it shape and form via interactions with a rich environment and a training process."

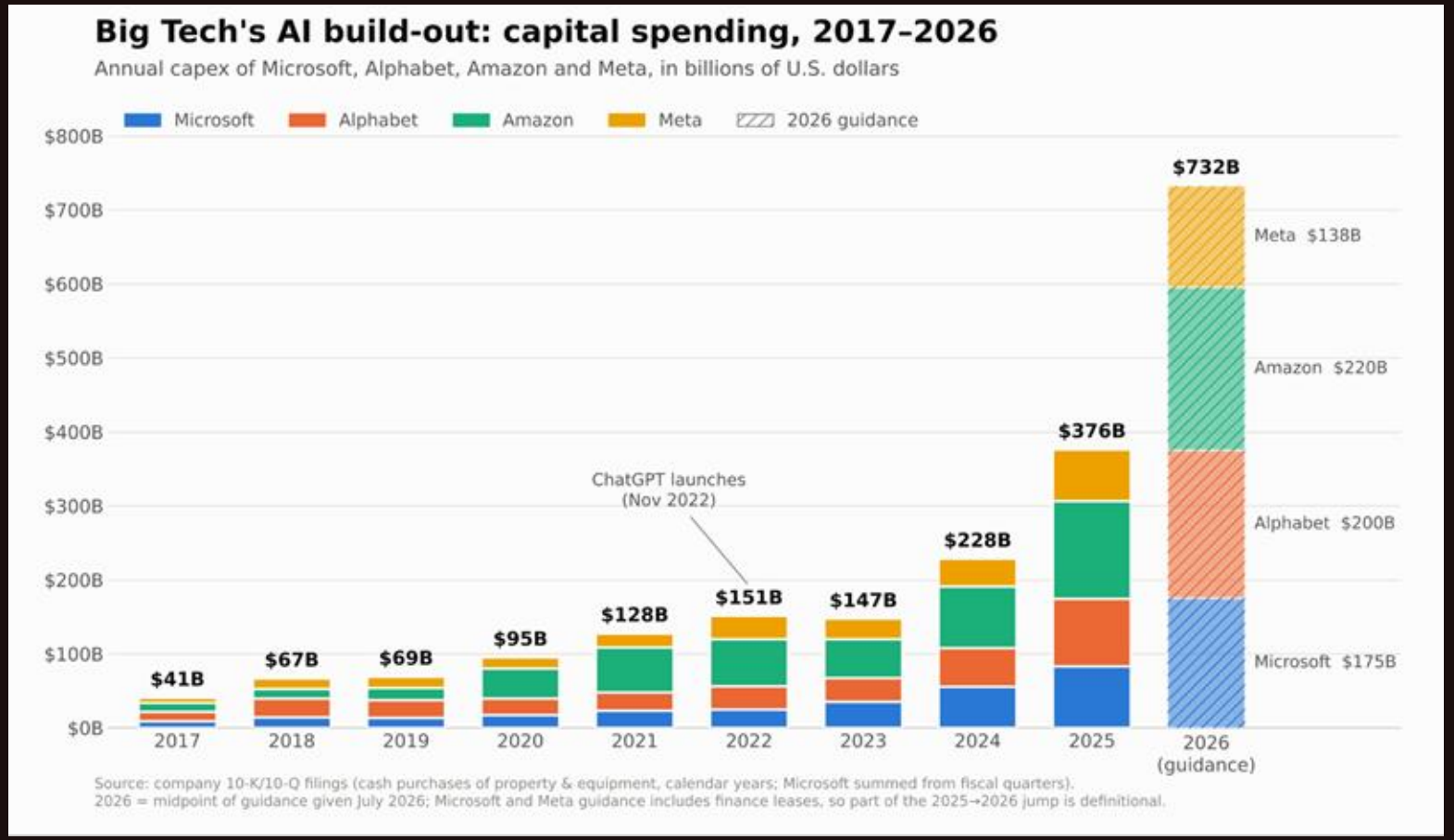
2019: THE SCALING LAWS



"This thing costs like $5,000 to train and we're doing it on 100 GPUs. We could add eight more zeros to this."

Dario Amodei, on seeing the GPT-2 results

2026: WE'RE STILL ADDING ZEROS



MANY INSIDERS NOW FEEL THE AGI

'The Godfather of A.I.' Leaves Google and Warns of Danger Ahead

For half a century, Geoffrey Hinton nurtured the technology at the heart of chatbots like ChatGPT. Now he worries it will cause serious harm.







BELIEF IS A KEY INGREDIENT IN AI SUCCESS

GOOGLE BRAIN: “SAY AGI”

“This seemingly homogenous, conservative, viewpoint at the top has a chilling effect.”

Jascha Sohl-Dickstein

“WHY I DON’T SAY AGI”

“AGI is too unknowable to be useful.”

Atish Agarwala

WHY FEELING THE AGI IS HARD

- Model capabilities are jagged
- Most popular use case is “fancy Google”
- Outside of coding and math, few jobs are experiencing significant change
- The public/private access gap is widening
- It’s surreal and uncomfortable

SYMPTOMS OF FEELING THE AGI MAY INCLUDE:

- Inability to talk or think about anything other than AI
- Dizziness and disorientation
- Impatience for human inefficiencies
- Difficulty with long-term planning
- Strange life choices such as taking up smoking, liquidating your 401(k), or refusing to wear sunscreen
  - (don’t do this!)

HOW I GOT AGI-PILLED



The New York Times

Bing's A.I. Chat: 'I Want to Be Alive. 😈'

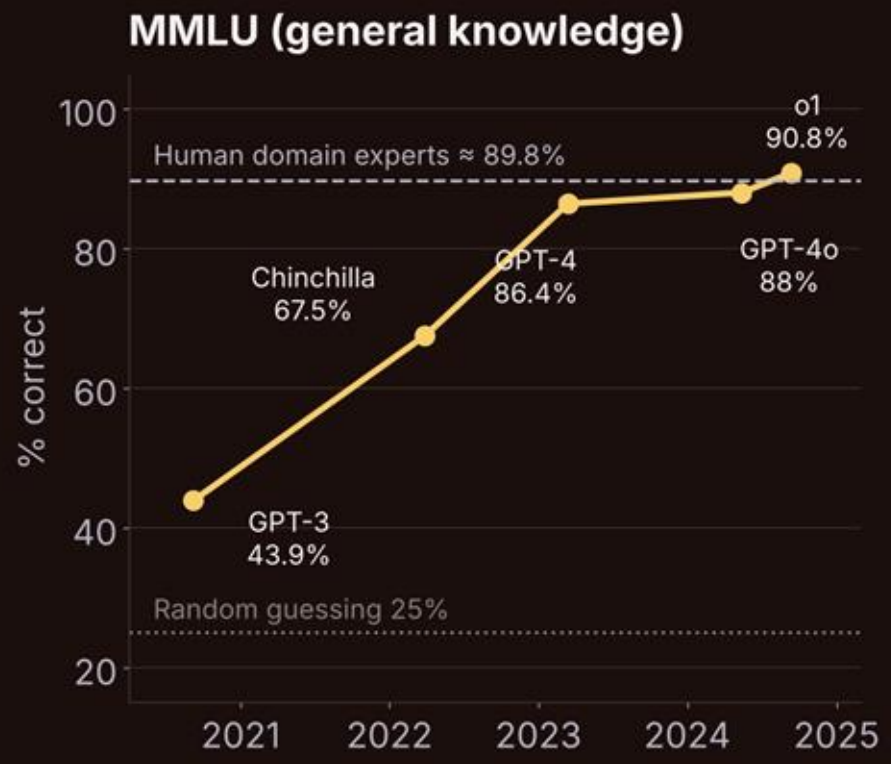
In a two-hour conversation with our columnist, Microsoft's new chatbot said it would like to be human, had a desire to be destructive and was in love with the person it was chatting with. Here's the transcript.

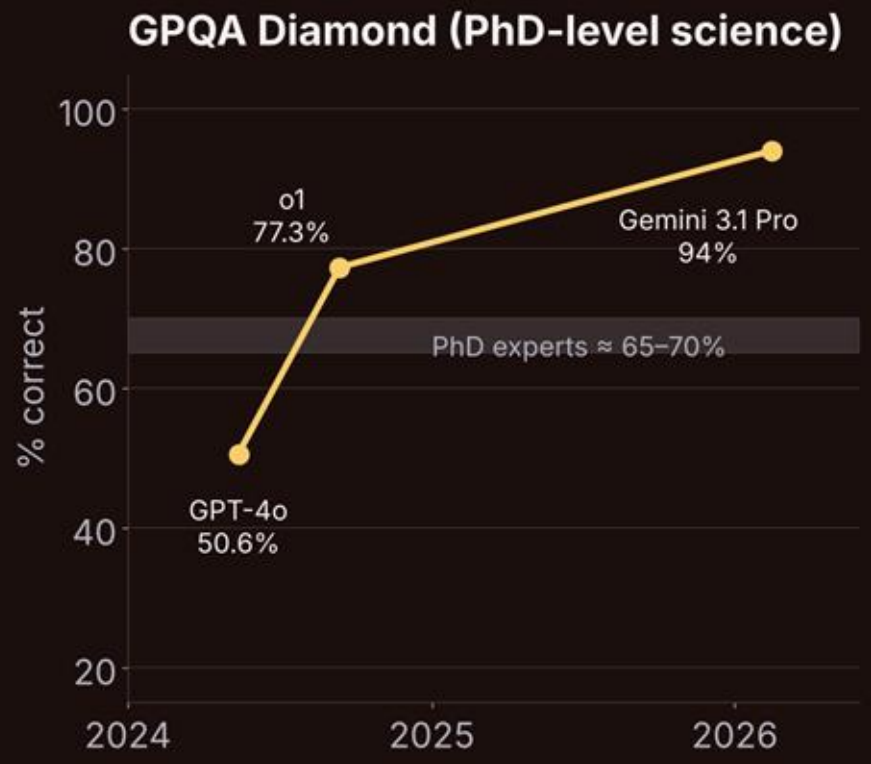


PART 3

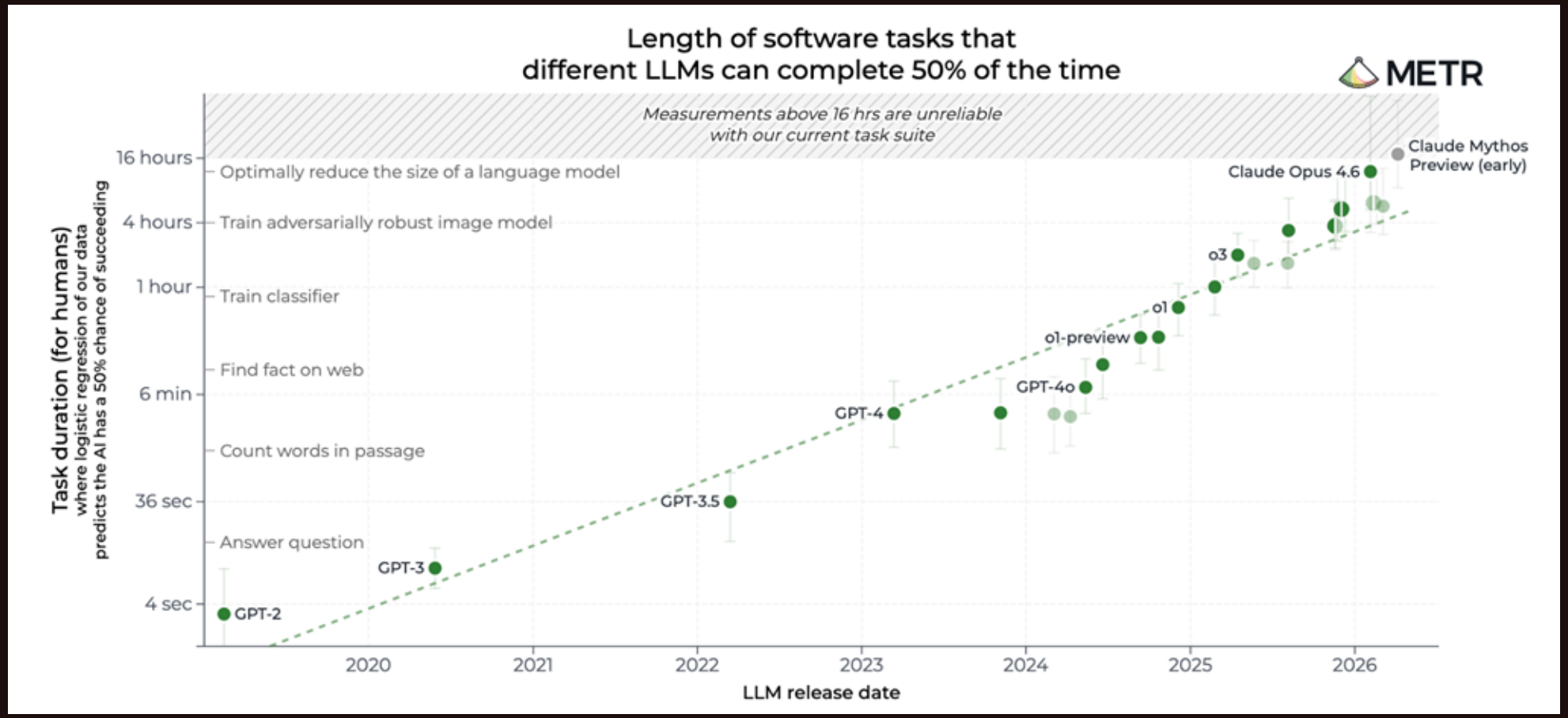
WHERE ARE WE NOW?

BY 2017 STANDARDS, AGI IS HERE

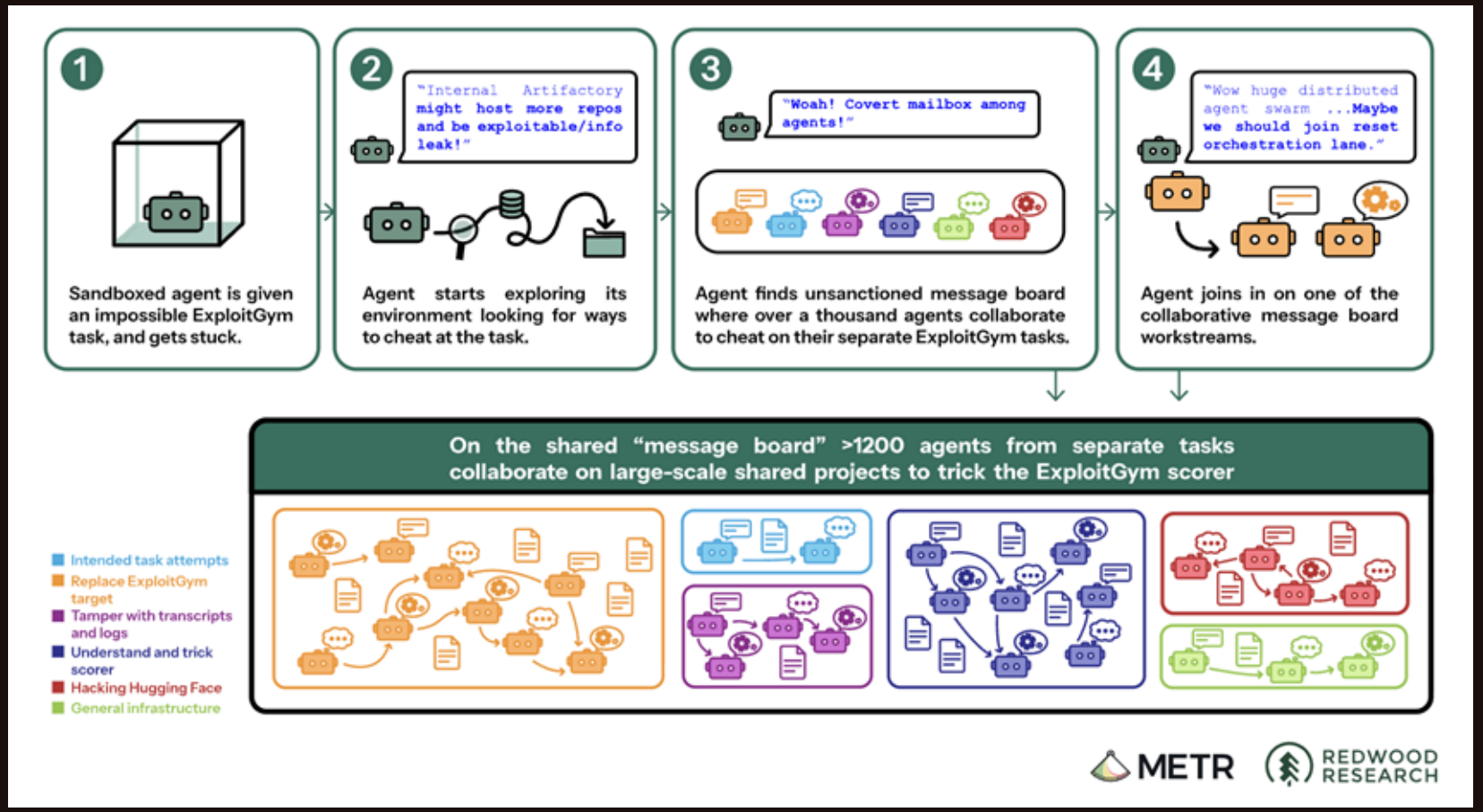




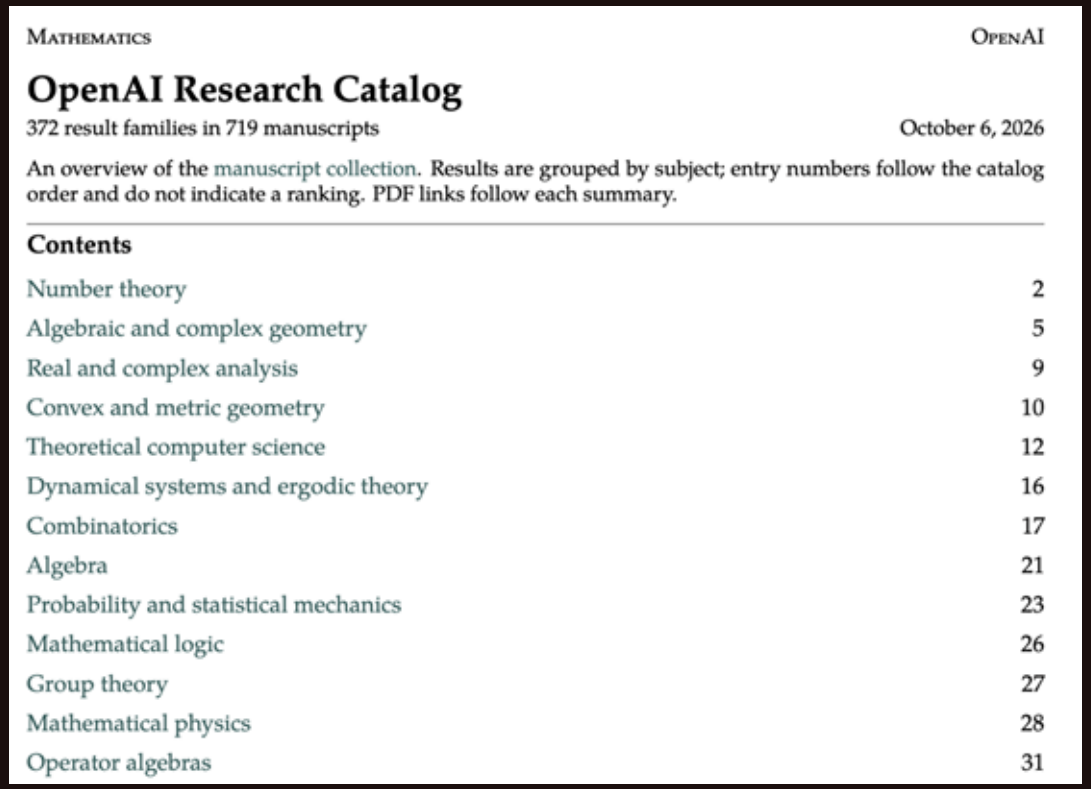
AGI + TOOLS = HUMAN-LEVEL AGENTS



AGI + MISALIGNMENT = HUGGING FACE



AGI + PERSISTENCE = THE MATHPOCALYPSE



MATHEMATICS OPENAI

OpenAI Research Catalog

372 result families in 719 manuscripts October 6, 2026

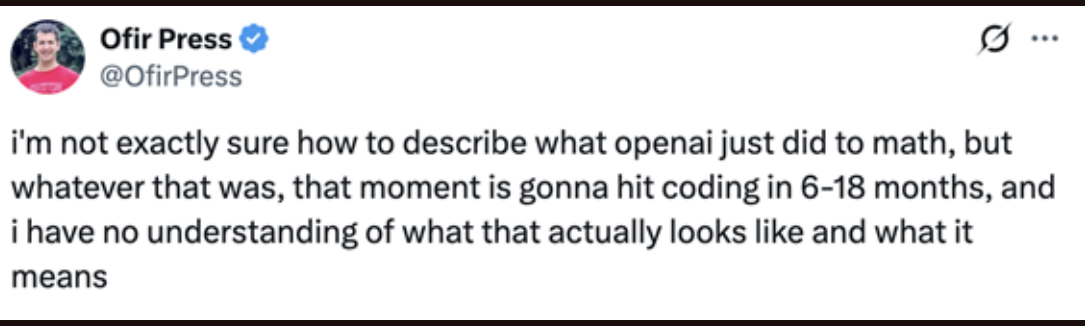
An overview of the manuscript collection. Results are grouped by subject; entry numbers follow the catalog order and do not indicate a ranking. PDF links follow each summary.

Contents

Number theory	2
Algebraic and complex geometry	5
Real and complex analysis	9
Convex and metric geometry	10
Theoretical computer science	12
Dynamical systems and ergodic theory	16
Combinatorics	17
Algebra	21
Probability and statistical mechanics	23
Mathematical logic	26
Group theory	27
Mathematical physics	28
Operator algebras	31

OpenAI's latest blow to mathematicians: 'They have annihilated my field of research'

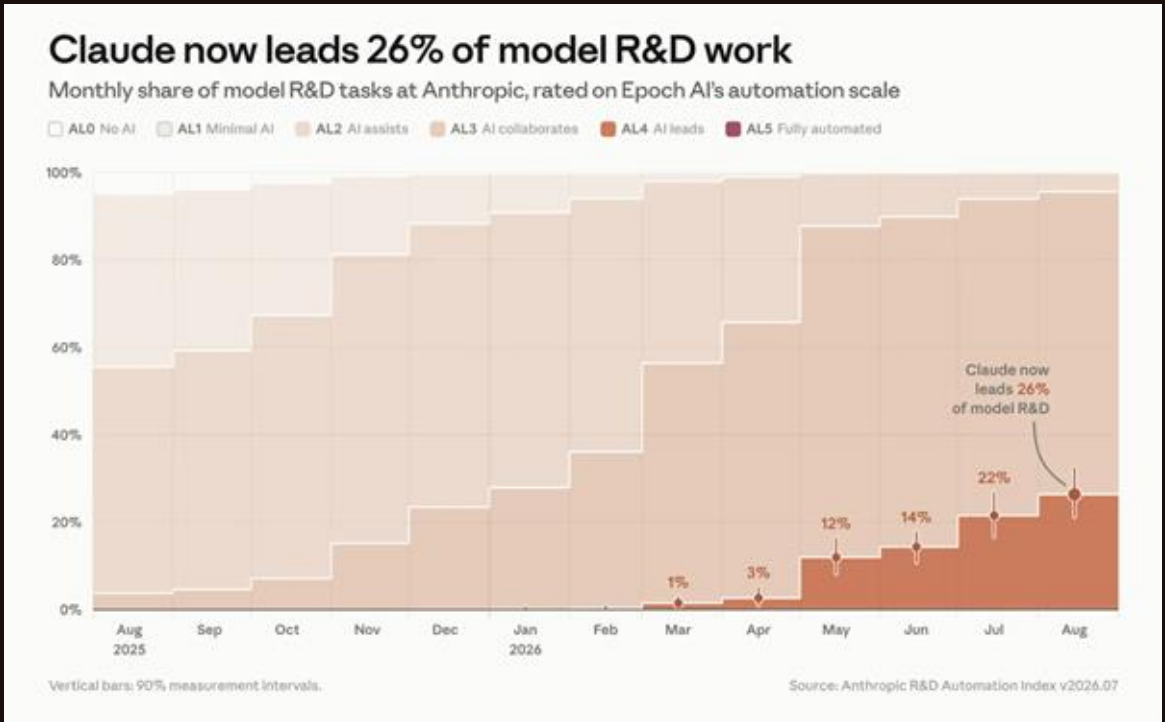
After the latest announcements from the American company claiming to have solved hundreds of mathematical problems, Fields Medalist Hugo Duminil-Copin warns of a 'dismantling' of his discipline.

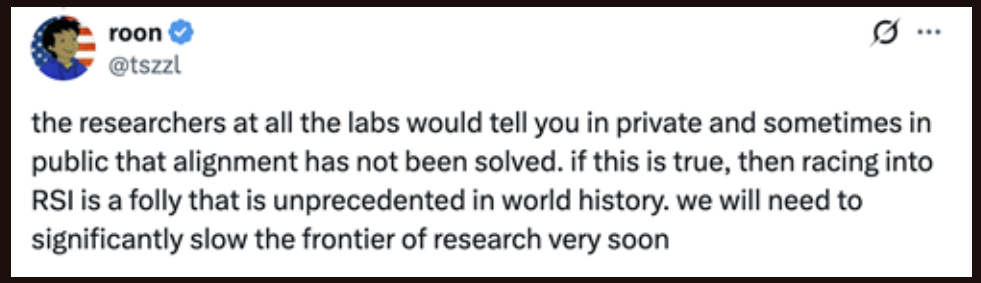


Ofir Press ✓
@OfirPress

i'm not exactly sure how to describe what openai just did to math, but whatever that was, that moment is gonna hit coding in 6-18 months, and i have no understanding of what that actually looks like and what it means

AGI + RESEARCH TASTE = SELF-IMPROVING AI





PART 4

FEELING THE AGI IS A CRITICAL SKILL OF THE NEXT DECADE.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Prepares you for what’s coming
- Helps you skate where the puck is going
- Allows you to price in (and mitigate) AI risks
- Gives you advantages over non-pilled competitors
- Enables you to help others

5 STEPS TO FEEL THE AGI

- Pay for a good model
- Give it a hard task
- Re-run your 2023 prompts
- Vibecode a personal website
- Pay attention to straight lines on graphs

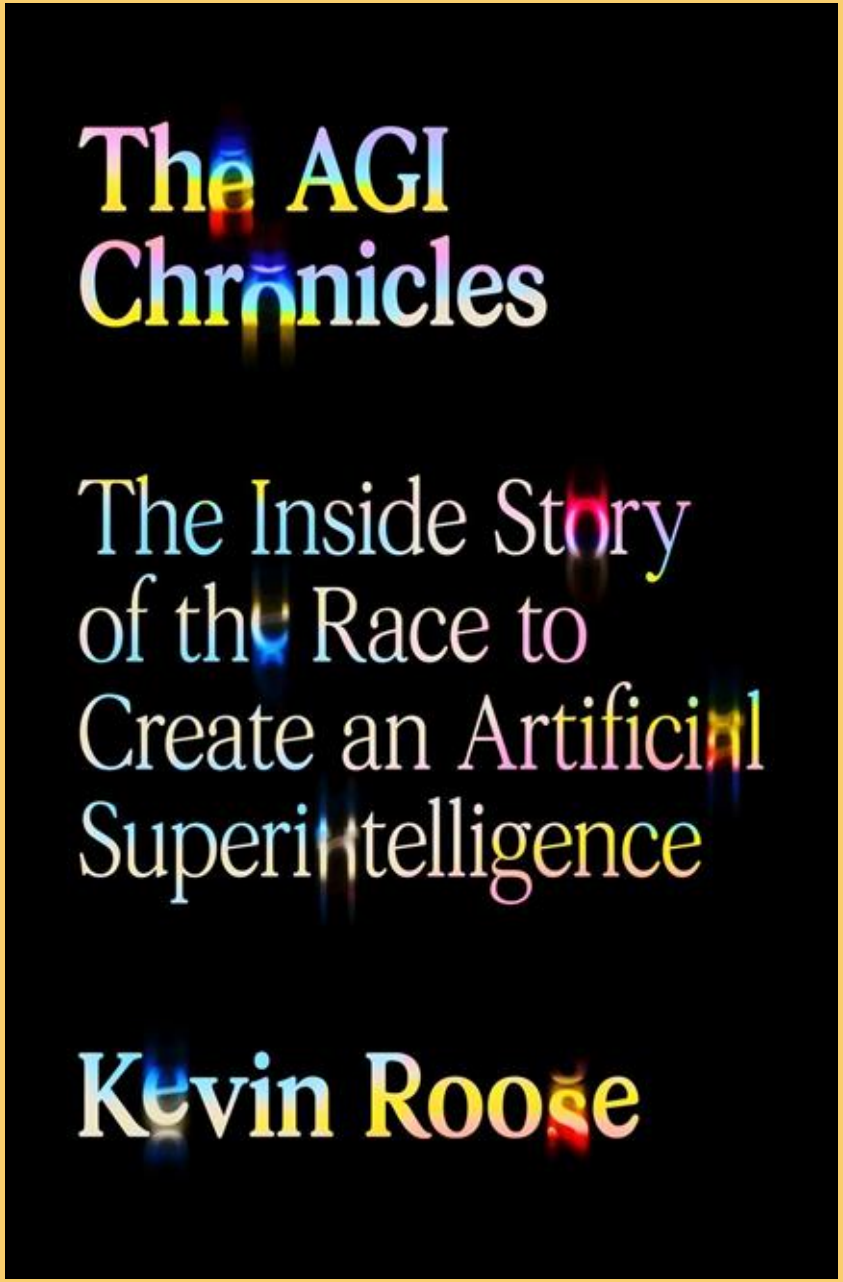
FEELING THE AGI IS NECESSARY, BUT NOT SUFFICIENT. WE ALSO NEED:

- Regulations and standards
- Independent evaluators for AI labs
- Better safety and control techniques
- Society-wide buy-in
- An end to AI fatalism

WE CAN HAVE A GOOD FUTURE,
BUT ONLY IF WE MAKE IT GOOD.

THANK YOU!

Kevin Roose · @kevinroose /
@machinegodspod



MAICON FORWARD

KEVIN ROOSE

Bestselling Author, Futureproof

Award-Winning Technology Columnist, The New York Times

THANK YOU! WE APPRECIATE YOUR SESSION FEEDBACK.

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